First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office:
M: 10-12, **Tu**: 9-2, **W**: 10-12, **Th**: 9-12 & 1-5, **F**: 10-12
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Monday is Pastor Jessica's Sabbath.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Reader: Nancy Holland

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

June 30, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager

27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Sixth Sunday After Pentecost June 30, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:
"As my sufferings mounted I soon realized that there were two ways in which I could respond to my situation — either to react with bitterness or seek to transform the suffering into a creative force. I decided to follow the latter course." — Martin Luther King Jr.

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

One: Within this community
All: We experience God's unconditional love
One: Within this community
All: We rejoice in the risen Christ
One: Within this community
All: We awaken to the Holy Spirit
One: Within this community
All: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**
Precious God, be upon us this day in our worship and praise. Strengthen our faith in the inclusive and loving teachings of Christ and may the Holy Spirit be our guide as we pray and discern our gathering as your church to be the disciples of

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
- ➔ Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- ➔ First Congregational Church of St Albans
- ➔ Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- ➔ Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- ➔ Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- ➔ Congregational Church of So. Hero
- ➔ Our local Girl Scout Troop
- ➔ As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
- ➢ F/GI Community Action
- ➢ Voices Against Violence
- ➢ Samaritan House
- ➢ Restorative Justice Center
- ➢ Pathways
- ➢ Reach-Up
- ➢ Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

God's realm in the world today. We pray this in the name of Jesus the Christ. Amen.

Hymn*

"Lift Every Voice and Sing" (1,3) NCH 593

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**
O God, the creator of all things based on love. You created us in your image of love and there have been times we have fallen short of that love, not only to you but to each other and all of creation. I ask for your forgiveness and from you, present today, my siblings, sisters and brothers in Christ. I thank you for the comforting strength and compassion of the Holy Spirit to do better in bringing love and grace and all I do. In Jesus' name I pray. Amen

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Special Music

Still See Your Face
for my mother (Sept. 1940- June 2004) S. Conrady

Scripture Reading

Mark 5:21-43

Morning Reflection

Holistic Medicine

Hymn*

"Amazing Grace" (1,3,5) NCH 547

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

Choral Response To Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee.*"

Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"This is My Song" NCH 591

Benediction

Postlude

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ Stephen McLaughlin Thank You for preaching and running the service last Sunday while Pastor Jessica was away!

Ladies' Breakfast - All Are Welcome! 9 A.M., July 14th, at the Saint Albans Diner

Church Street Festival
July 27
Volunteers needed!

Clock Winders Wanted!
There is a signup sheet on the door to the Bridal entrance. This sign up sheet is for clock winding volunteers. If you are interested but have never wound the clock before, please talk to Park Newton or Greg Beeman for more information.

Online Giving:

Wi-Fi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123

